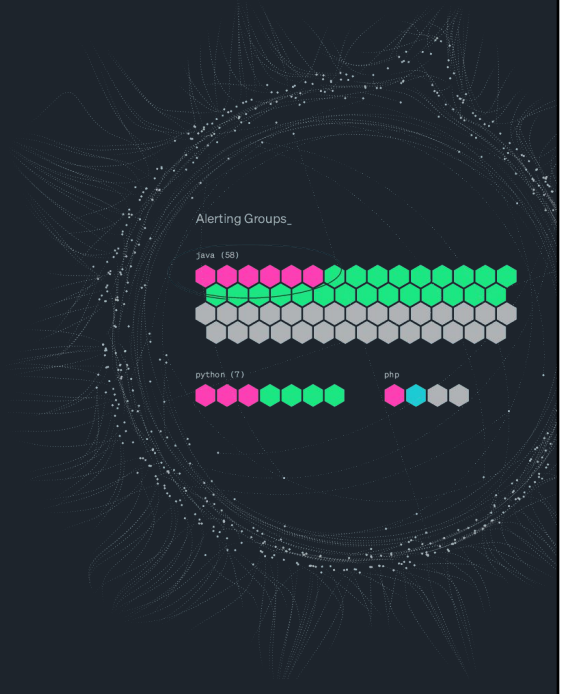


New Relic Alerts Fundamentals

Phil Weber
Technical Instructor

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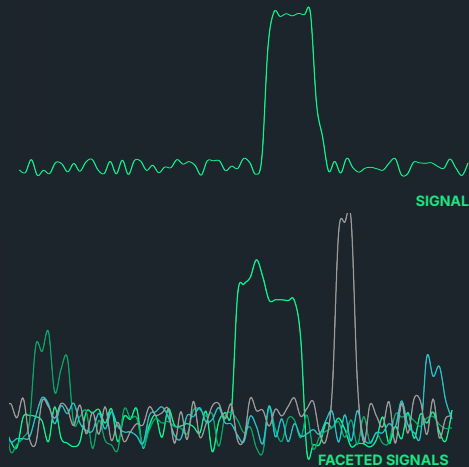


Agenda

- 01 Alerts terminology and concepts
- 02 Lab: Creating alert conditions and policies
- 03 Lab: Configuring workflows and destinations
- 04 Managing issues
- 05 Muting rules
- 06 Additional resources

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What is a "Signal"?



Acquisition Detection Noise reduction Routing Notify

Signal

- **Any data** being sent to New Relic
- Result of an **NRQL query** against incoming data
- If you can **query it you can alert** on it!

Faceted signal

- Faceting the query results in **multiple signals**
- Each signal can trigger separate alerts

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Signals to alert on

Some ideas:

- Host metrics: CPU, memory, disk space, restarts
- APM golden metrics: Latency, throughput, errors
- Key transactions
- Synthetic journeys: Success rate, duration
- Log data: Error messages, business data
- Business metrics: Customers, sales

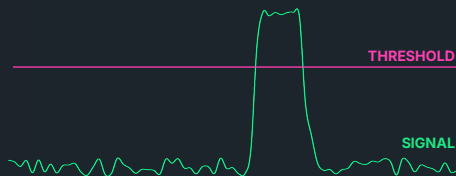


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Conditions

Signal acquisition and evaluation



Some examples

Signal	Threshold
% Error rate	% error > 5%
Average basket value	median(value) < \$20
Login attempts per user	uniqueCount(user) > 10

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[Documentation on alert conditions](#)

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Acquisition Detection Noise reduction Routing Notify

Signal query

Defined by NRQL query including optional WHERE and FACET clauses.

Guided wizard available to help build.

**Additional non-NRQL conditions soon to be deprecated*

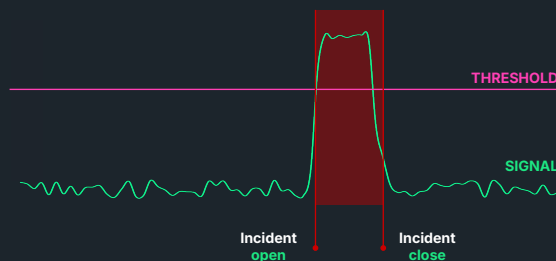
Threshold

Value, which if breached by signal for a defined time period, will trigger an alert event to be opened.

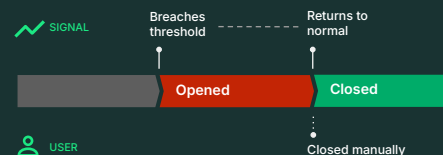
A threshold can be set for both **warning** and **critical**

Alert Events

Signal breach detection



Alert event lifecycle



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Acquisition Detection Noise reduction Routing Notify

- Alert events **open** when a **signal breaches the threshold** defined in a condition.
- Events **close automatically** when the signal is no longer in breach.
- There will be some **latency** between signal breaching and event opening based on condition settings.
- Alert event will open for **each signal facet**
- Events may be **manually closed** by user

Incidents

Incident management and noise reduction

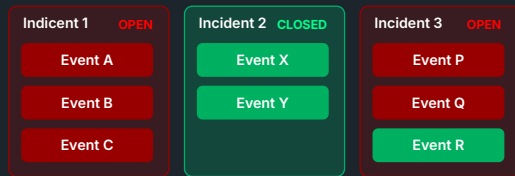
Acquisition

Detection

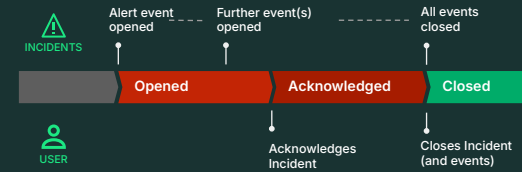
Noise reduction

Routing

Notify



Incident lifecycle



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[Documentation about incidents](#)

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Incidents **group alert events together**, reducing noise and driving notification workflows.

- Incidents are **opened when incidents open**
- Incidents can **contain multiple alert events** based on policy preference or correlation decisions
- Incidents **close automatically** when all contained events have closed or if inactive for defined period
- Incidents can be **manually closed**, which close all contained alert events.

Policies

Predetermined event grouping

Acquisition

Detection

Noise reduction

Routing

Notify

FEWER
ISSUES

1

Per
Policy



Only one incident will be open at a time for the **entire policy**.

- Requires immediate action and closing the incidents to be effective

2

Per
Condition

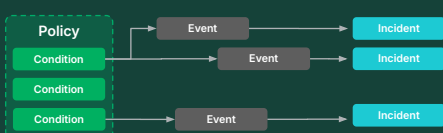


One incident will be open at a time for **each condition** in your policy.

- Useful for policies containing conditions that focus on entities that perform the same job

3

Per
Incident



An incident will be created for **every alert event of each condition** in your policy.

- Useful if you need to be notified of every violation or if you have an external system where you want to send alert notifications

MORE
ISSUES

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[Documentation on alert policies / issue preference](#)

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Training account credentials

Log out of other New Relic accounts (or open private browser window)

URL: <https://one.newrelic.com/>

Email: learn@newrelicuniversity.com

The instructor will provide the password

Lab: Alert conditions and policy

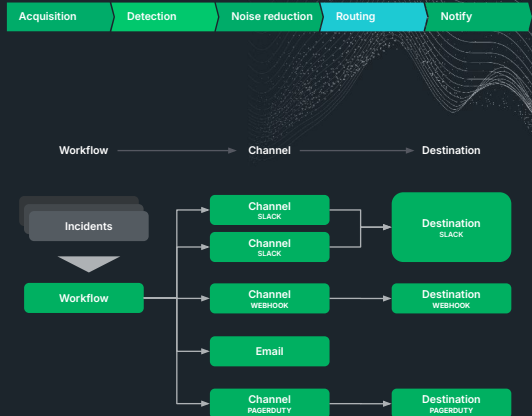
In the **NRU Training** account:

1. Select *Alerts > Alert Conditions*
2. Using *Guided Mode*, create an alert condition that will open a critical alert event if any *APM service* in the *Production* environment has a response time greater than 500 ms for at least 5 minutes
3. Add the alert condition to a new alert policy. Give it a name you will recognize, such as *[Your Name] Policy*
4. Stop when you see the button labeled *Save & set up notifications*

Workflows

Notification triage and routing

- Control **when** you want to receive notifications about incidents
- Notify correct teams** based on incident context
- Channels offer comprehensive **payload templating** options
- Enrich notifications** with additional New Relic data



Channels allow **multiple different message payloads** to be sent to **multiple destinations**

Destinations

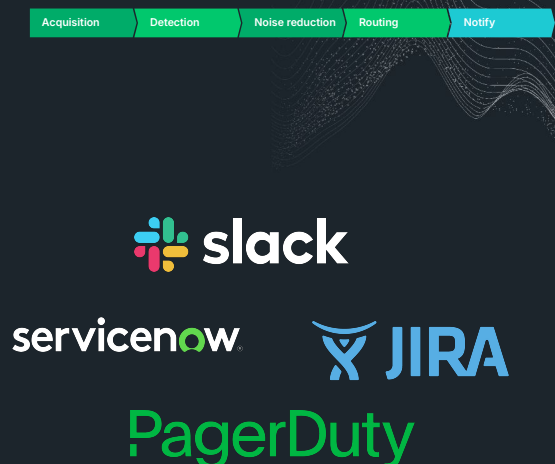
Notification dispatch

Destination inform **people** or **third-party services** about issues state change.

Supported destinations:

- Email & mobile push
- Native: Jira*, ServiceNow*, PagerDuty*, Slack
- Webhook: e.g. OpsGenie, MS Teams, etc..
- AWS EventBridge

Destinations **setup once per account** and can be used by multiple workflows.



*two way integrations

Lab: Workflows and destinations

1. Click the button labeled *Save & set up notifications*
2. Give your workflow a name you will recognize, such as *[Your name] workflow*
3. Under **Notify**, select *Email*. Create a new destination with your email address
4. Check your email and click the button authorising New Relic to send email notifications to your address
5. *Optional*: Click *Test workflow*. Did you receive an email?
6. Click the *Activate workflow* button in the lower-right corner

Lab: NRQL alert conditions

Perform the following tasks in NRU Training account:

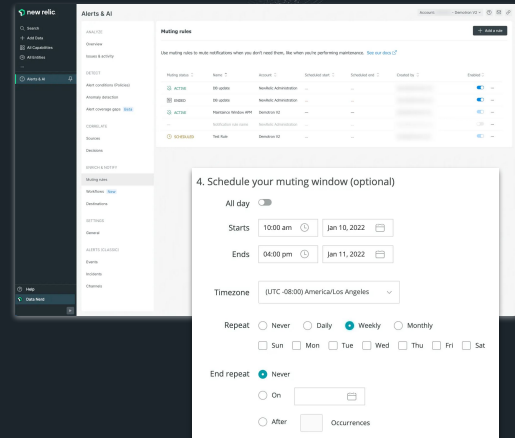
1. Build a query that returns the average CPU utilization for any host running the *New Relic Pet Clinic* APM application
2. Create a *critical* alert event if the query returns a value greater than 50% for at least 5 minutes
3. *Optionally*, add a threshold that creates a *warning* event if CPU utilization is greater than 20% for at least 3 minutes
4. Add the new condition to the alert policy you created earlier

Muting rules

Temporarily mute notifications



- Mute **incident notifications**, for instance when **performing maintenance** or known **down periods**
- Incidents are **still generated and queryable**, they just don't send notifications.
- **Filter incidents** by attribute, can target multiple workflows and destinations.
- Muting rules can be **scheduled and repeatable**



Resources

- [Alerts documentation](#)

Blog posts:

- [Best practices for fixing your alerts](#)
- [Alert! Best practices for alert quality](#)

Documentation links:

- [Alert conditions](#)
- [Issues and incident management](#)
- [Alert policies](#)
- [Issue incident grouping preference](#)
- [Workflows in New Relic](#)
- [Notification destination integrations](#)



Data Bytes

Short how-to videos covering a variety of topics

- [The new alert condition creation form](#)
- [Never miss an alert with New Relic's mobile app](#)
- [Setting muting rules for workflows](#)
- [How to set up webhook destinations for workflows](#)
- [Set up sliding window aggregation in your alert conditions](#)
- [Alert aggregation methods explained](#)

Destination setup guides

- [How to configure workflow email destinations](#)
- [Set up a JIRA workflow destination](#)
- [Send notifications to Slack using workflow destinations](#)
- [How to configure workflow Pagerduty destinations](#)
- [How to configure ServiceNow workflow destinations](#)